

4 resident evil

It's releasing. Really



The number of times *Resident Evil 4* missed its schedule release dates almost had us dismissing it as vapourware. This is the third of Capcom's biggest console games to make it to the PC, after *Onimusha 3* and *Devil May Cry 3*—both of which were handled very half-heartedly and sported keyboard controls that looked like they were mapped by retarded monkeys with blindfolds on. But where *Onimusha* and *DMC* were half-hearted, *Resident Evil 4* makes it to three-quarter-hearted.

For those who came in late—2005's *Resident Evil 4* has you playing Leon Kennedy sent to a village in Europe to rescue the president's daughter, who has been kidnapped by a strange cult. Instead of the zombies from the previous games, you must fight parasite-infected villagers on your quest. The game raked in the accolades for its excellent environment design, tense atmosphere and the incredible boss fights. It does have its sore points, though—you can't strafe, and the action isn't as fast-paced as it should be.

The PC held incredible potential for this game—the ability to use the mouse for fast movements meant that the game's difficulty level could be kicked up a notch with no problems, and new graphics cards could add another ounce of zing to the brilliant atmosphere. Sadly, Capcom chose to ignore all that and feed us a direct port that doesn't even have mouse support. The keyboard controls, while not completely idiotic, don't do much for the playability of the game—don't even go near it if you don't own a good game controller, especially considering that in-game instructions don't mention any keyboard keys. You will also hate the fact that all the dynamic lighting and shadows have been ripped out of it. Half of the atmosphere is the lighting, and without it, *RE4* looks flat as a board.

If you have a PS2, go buy *RE4* for the PS2 (if you haven't already). Buy the PC version only if you're a masochist who wants to experience the horrors of seeing a good game treated like trash.

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